STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE			P-4220	
	SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA **GREG LONDON** **SHERIFF**	DATE ISSUED 06/01/06	DATE REVISED **02/20/25**	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
		APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		
CHAPTER TITLE ROAD PATROL	RESOURCES			
SUBJECT BUILDING SEARCHES	CROSS REFERENCE P-3440 ALARMS P-3441 RESIDENTIAL ALARMS P-3442 BUSINESS ALARMS P-3500 COMMUNICATIONS PROCEDURES P-4800 CRIME INVESTIGATION P-4810 CRIME SCENE P-6600 CRITERIA FOR K-9 UNIT ACTIVATION			

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to establish procedures for conducting building searches when there is reason to believe a suspect is on location.

II. Policy:

In order to detect crimes in progress or crimes that have recently occurred, the Sarpy County Sheriff's Office shall conduct searches of buildings found unsecured. An unsecured building may be discovered by deputies in a variety of situations including alarms, business checks, and calls for service. The following procedures are intended to reduce risk to deputies and other citizens and to increase the likelihood of apprehension of criminals.

III. Procedures:

A. Prior to Building Search-Deputy Responsibilities:

1. A deputy discovering an open door or window on a building shall immediately notify Communications of the following:

a) The name of the business (if applicable).
b) The address of the building.
c) The specific location on the building of the open door or window.

2. The discovering deputy shall take a position of cover and observe the building and await back-up deputies.

3. Deputies should not enter an unsecured building alone unless entry is necessary to prevent loss of life.

4. If available, back-up deputies should take positions on opposite corners of the building and observe all entrances and exits (see Figure 1).

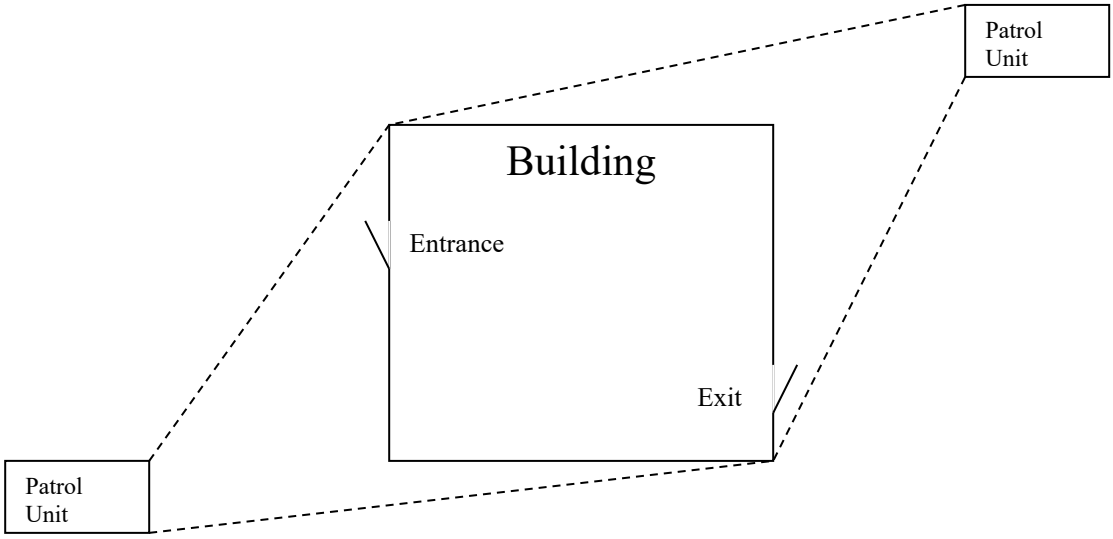

Figure 1

5. Deputies may contact the owner or business representative prior to beginning the search. The owner or representative may provide a description of the building interior and information of potential hazards, but should not be allowed to enter the building until deputies have conducted a search.

6. A thorough search of the exterior of the building should be conducted prior to entry. Attention should be paid to vehicles parked at or near the building to ensure they are unoccupied. Communications should be notified of any vehicles near the building, including license plates.

7. If it is a large building or there is probable cause to believe a crime has been committed at the building and that the suspect is still on location, deputies should consider the use of a K-9 unit to assist with the building search (see P-6600 Criteria for K-9 Unit Activation).

B. Entry and Search-Deputy Responsibilities:

1. Two deputies shall conduct the building search. The two deputies shall maintain contact with one another and function as one search team.

2. Generally, the deputies should have weapons drawn during the search.

3. One deputy shall search while the second deputy covers the unknown areas.

4. In a multi-level building, deputies shall, generally, completely search the bottom floor before moving up.

5. If an individual is encountered, he or she should be handcuffed, pat searched, and removed from the building. After the individual is secured outside, the deputies shall return and search the entire building, including those areas already searched.

6. Deputies should use caution while conducting the search to preserve any possible evidence.

C. Completion of the Search-Deputy Responsibilities:

1. Deputies shall notify communications when the search is complete and advise the results of the search (e.g. building is clear or suspect was located).

2. If there appears to be no unauthorized entry, the owner or representative may be allowed to enter and ensure no crime has occurred.

3. If the premises is found to have been entered but no suspects are located, the building shall be treated as a crime scene (see P-4810 Crime Scene).

4. If a suspect(s) is apprehended, the deputies shall conduct an investigation regarding the individual's identity and possible crimes (see P-4800 Crime Investigation).

5. If the owner or representative cannot be reached:

   a) Deputies shall leave a business card in plain view with a notation on the back regarding the deputies' search of the building.

   b) The building should be secured, if possible.

   c) The involved deputies shall notify a supervisor of the situation.

D. Building Searches-Supervisor Responsibilities:

1. If possible, an on-duty shift supervisor shall respond to all building searches where there is probable cause to believe a suspect is still on location.

2. The on-duty shift supervisor shall determine the need for a K-9 unit.

3. If a suspect(s) is apprehended as a result of a building search, the shift supervisor shall notify the on-duty watch commander or the ADC.